The Meta Ads Campaign Deployment Guide

Deploy Facebook & Instagram Ad Campaigns With One Claude Code Command

Most people spend 45 minutes clicking through Meta Ads Manager every time they launch a campaign. Video uploads, ad copy, UTMs, pixel setup, targeting. The same 20 clicks, every time.

This guide walks you through building a Claude Code skill that does the entire pipeline with one command. From "I have video ads ready" to "campaign is live on Meta" without ever opening Ads Manager.

Everything deploys PAUSED. You review in Ads Manager, then activate when you are ready.

This guide assumes you have never set up Claude Code or a Meta Developer App before. We start from zero.

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1. Set Up Claude Code (If You Haven't Already)

If you already have Claude Code running in VS Code, skip to Section 2.

1.1 Install VS Code

Download Visual Studio Code from code.visualstudio.com. It is free and works on Mac, Windows, and Linux. Install it and open it.

1.2 Install the Claude Code Extension

1. Open VS Code
2. Click the **Extensions** icon on the left sidebar (it looks like four squares)

3. Search for **"Claude Code"**
4. Find the one published by **Anthropic** and click **Install**

1.3 Sign In

1. Click the Claude Code icon in the top-right toolbar (the spark icon)
2. Sign in with your Anthropic account
3. If you do not have an account, create one at claude.ai

1.4 Verify It Works

Open the Claude Code panel and type:

```
What files are in this project?
```

If Claude responds with a list of your files, you are set up. Claude Code can now read your project, write code, run terminal commands, and execute skills.

1.5 What Are Skills?

Skills are custom commands you build inside Claude Code. They live in a folder called `.claude/skills/` in your project. Each skill has a `SKILL.md` file that tells Claude exactly what to do when you type the command.

For this guide, the skill is `/meta-ads-campaign`. When you type it, Claude Code runs a 6-phase pipeline that deploys an entire Meta ad campaign from your terminal.

You do not need to write the skill from scratch. The skill file is included in this guide (Section 3). You just need to set up the prerequisites first.

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2. Set Up the Meta Developer App

Before Claude Code can talk to Meta's advertising API, you need three things:

1. A **Meta Developer App** (this is how Meta authenticates API requests)
2. An **access token** (the key that lets your app manage ads)
3. The right **permissions** granted to that token

This section walks you through all three.

2.1 Create a Meta Developer Account

1. Go to developers.facebook.com
2. Click **Get Started** in the top right
3. Log in with the Facebook account that manages your business's ad account
4. Accept the developer terms
5. You now have a Meta Developer account

2.2 Create a New App

1. From the developer dashboard, click **Create App**
2. Choose **Other** as the use case
3. Select **Business** as the app type
4. Give it a name like "My Ad Deployer" or "Claude Code Ads"
5. Select the Business Portfolio that contains your ad account
6. Click **Create App**

Your app is now created. You will land on the app dashboard.

2.3 Add the Marketing API Product

1. On your app dashboard, scroll down to **Add Products to Your App**
2. Find **Marketing API** and click **Set Up**

3. This enables your app to manage ad campaigns, upload videos, and create ads

2.4 Create a System User

System users are special accounts designed for API access. Unlike personal tokens that expire in 60 days, system user tokens can be long-lived.

1. Go to business.facebook.com/settings
2. In the left menu, click **Users** then **System Users**
3. Click **Add** to create a new system user
4. Name it something like "Claude Code Deployer"
5. Set the role to **Admin** (needs full access to create campaigns)
6. Click **Create System User**

2.5 Assign the Ad Account

1. On the system user you just created, click **Add Assets**
2. Select **Ad Accounts**
3. Find your client's ad account and check the box
4. Grant **Full Control** (the deploy pipeline needs to create campaigns, ad sets, and ads)
5. Click **Save Changes**

2.6 Generate an Access Token

1. Still on the system user page, click **Generate New Token**
2. Select the app you created in Step 2.2
3. Check these permissions:
    - `ads_management` (create and manage campaigns)
    - `ads_read` (read campaign data)
    - `pages_read_engagement` (access Facebook Pages)
    - `pages_manage_ads` (publish ads through Pages)

4. Click **Generate Token**
5. **Copy the token immediately.** You will not see it again.

2.7 Add the Token to Your Project

Open your project's `.env` file (create one if it does not exist) and add:

```
META_ACCESS_TOKEN=paste_your_long_token_string_here
```

This is the only secret you need. Claude Code reads this token from your environment when deploying campaigns.

2.8 Find Your Ad Account ID

Your Meta ad account ID looks like `act_123456789`. Find it in:

1. Meta Ads Manager - it is in the URL when you open any campaign
2. Or in Business Settings under **Ad Accounts**

Write this down. You will need it when setting up the database.

2.9 Find Your Facebook Page ID

Every Meta ad is published through a Facebook Page. Find the Page ID:

1. Go to your Facebook Page
2. Click **About** (or **Page Transparency** on newer layouts)
3. Scroll to the bottom where it says **Page ID**

Or use the API:

```
GET https://graph.facebook.com/v21.0/me/accounts?access_token={your_token}
```

This returns all Pages your system user can access. The `id` field is the Page ID.

Quick Test

Verify your token works by running this in your terminal:

```
curl "https://graph.facebook.com/v21.0/me?access_token=YOUR_TOKEN_HERE"
```

If you get back a JSON object with your system user's name and ID, the token is working. If you get an error, double-check that you copied the full token and that the app is set up correctly.

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3. What the /meta-ads-campaign Skill Does

The skill runs a 6-phase pipeline that handles every step of deploying a Meta (Facebook/Instagram) ad campaign:

Phase 1: Gather Context Claude Code queries your database for the client, their ad account mapping, and asks you about the campaign scope: objective, audience, budget, landing pages, and video assets.

Phase 2: Create Campaign Record A campaign row is inserted into your database with status `draft`. Video assets are registered with file paths, dimensions, and format labels.

Phase 3: Generate Ad Copy For each video ad, Claude generates primary text, headline, description, and CTA type. You review everything before it is saved.

Phase 4: Generate UTMs UTM tracking parameters are generated per ad with a consistent naming convention. Full tracking URLs are built and stored.

Phase 5: Pre-Deploy Checklist A 10-point verification checklist is presented. Nothing moves forward until you explicitly approve.

Phase 6: Deploy to Meta The deploy API endpoint uploads videos, creates the campaign, ad set, creatives, and ads on Meta. Everything is created PAUSED. Every step is logged.

The entire pipeline is designed so you never lose work. If a deploy fails halfway through, you can re-run it. Already-uploaded videos are skipped. Already-created Meta objects are preserved.

4. Database Prerequisites

The skill needs a few database records to know which client, which ad account, and which videos to deploy. If you are using Supabase (like this project), you can run these queries in the SQL Editor.

4.1 Your Client Record

Your client needs a row in the `clients` table. Check if it exists:

```
SELECT id, name, slug FROM clients WHERE slug = 'your-client-slug';
```

If nothing comes back, add the client through your admin dashboard or insert directly:

```
INSERT INTO clients (name, slug)
VALUES ('Your Client Name', 'your-client-slug')
RETURNING id;
```

Save the `id` (UUID). You will need it for the next steps.

4.2 Ad Account Mapping

This tells the deploy pipeline which Meta ad account to use for this client:

```
INSERT INTO ad_account_mappings (client_id, platform, account_id, account_name,
is_active)
VALUES (
  'your-client-uuid',
  'meta_ads',
  'act_123456789',     -- your Meta ad account ID from Section 2.8
  'Client Ad Account', -- a friendly name
  true
);
```

4.3 Video Assets

Your video ads need to be rendered MP4 files accessible from your machine. Supported formats:

- **Vertical** (Stories/Reels): 1080×1920 (9:16)
- **Feed** (Square): 1080×1080 (1:1)
- **Landscape**: 1920×1080 (16:9)

If you render all three formats for the same ad, the pipeline creates a multi-format creative that serves the best format per placement automatically.

Quick Prerequisite Check

Run this single query to verify everything is ready:

```sql
SELECT
  c.slug,
  c.name,
  aam.account_id,
  aam.is_active
FROM clients c
LEFT JOIN ad_account_mappings aam
  ON aam.client_id = c.id AND aam.platform = 'meta_ads' AND aam.is_active = true
WHERE c.slug = 'your-client-slug';
```

You should see `is_active = true` and a valid `account_id`.

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5. Your First Campaign: Step by Step

5.1 Run the Skill

Open Claude Code in your project and type:

```
/meta-ads-campaign your-client-slug leads
```

The first argument is the client slug from your database. The second is the campaign objective. Options:

Objective	When to Use
`leads`	Lead generation campaigns (most common)
`traffic`	Drive visitors to a landing page
`awareness`	Brand awareness and reach
`conversions`	Website conversion events

5.2 Claude Code Asks Questions

Claude will ask you about six things:

1. **Campaign objective** - Already set from your argument, but you can override
2. **Target audience** - Geographic region, age range
3. **Budget** - Daily budget in dollars (e.g., "$20/day")
4. **Landing page** - Where clicks go (e.g., `https://yourclient.com/free-quote`)
5. **Funnel structure** - Single ad set or split by funnel stage
6. **Video assets** - Which rendered videos to include

Answer conversationally. Claude handles all the data formatting and database insertions.

5.3 Review Ad Copy

Claude generates ad copy for each video and presents it for review:

```
Ad 1: "Rate Hikes"
  Primary text: Your electricity rate just went up again...
  Headline: Stop Paying More Every Year
  Description: Free solar savings report
  CTA: LEARN_MORE

Approve? (y/n)
```

Nothing is saved until you approve. You can ask Claude to rewrite any piece.

5.4 Pre-Deploy Checklist

Before anything touches Meta, Claude presents a 10-point checklist:

- All video assets exist at their file paths
- All ad copy reviewed and approved
- UTM URLs are clean
- Geographic targeting validated
- Landing pages live
- Facebook Page ID set
- Ad account mapping active
- Budget set
- Content details accurate
- No special ad category violations

You approve, and Claude sets the campaign status to `ready`.

5.5 Deploy

Claude calls the deploy endpoint. You will see output like:

```
Uploading video 1/10: Rate Hikes - Vertical... done
Uploading video 2/10: Rate Hikes - Feed... done
Creating campaign... PAUSED
Discovering pixel... PSS Pixel (123456)
Creating ad set... done
Creating ad 1/10... done
...
All 10 ads deployed successfully. Campaign is PAUSED.
```

Everything is PAUSED. Open Meta Ads Manager to review, then activate when ready.

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6. How the Deploy Pipeline Works

When you trigger deployment, here is what happens under the hood:

Video Upload (with Resume)

Each video file is uploaded to Meta via the Graph API. If a video was already uploaded (has a stored Meta video ID), it is skipped. This means a failed deploy can be re-run without re-uploading gigabytes of video.

Campaign Creation

The campaign is created with status PAUSED. Budget is set at the campaign level when using Campaign Budget Optimization (CBO), which is the default. The API expects budget in cents. The pipeline converts your dollar amount automatically.

Pixel Auto-Discovery

The pipeline finds the active Meta Pixel on the ad account and attaches it to the ad set. This means conversion tracking is set up automatically. If no pixel is found, the deploy continues but logs a warning.

Ad Set with Advantage+ Audience

The ad set is created with your targeting and Advantage+ audience enabled. This lets Meta expand beyond your seed audience for better results. It is always enabled.

UTM Generation

For each ad, tracking URLs are built:

```
https://yourclient.com/free-quote?utm_source=meta&utm_medium=paid_social&utm_campaign=your-client-march-2026-leads&utm_content=v1-tof-rate-hikes-news
```

Multi-Format Creatives

If your ad has multiple video formats (vertical, feed, landscape), the pipeline creates a multi-format creative. Meta serves the best format per placement automatically. If multi-format fails, it falls back to single-video.

Everything Logged

Every step is logged to the `ad_deploy_log` table with the request, response, status, and any errors. Complete audit trail.

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7. Geographic Targeting

Getting the region key wrong is the most common deployment mistake. Meta's geolocation keys are not intuitive, and a wrong key can target the wrong country entirely.

Always Validate via the API

Before deploying, look up the correct region key:

```
GET https://graph.facebook.com/v21.0/search?
type=adgeolocation&location_types=region&q=Saskatchewan&access_token={token}
```

The response includes a `key` field. Verify three things:

1. The `key` matches what you expect
2. The `country_code` is correct (e.g., `CA` for Canada)
3. The `name` is the right region

Common Mistakes

Wrong region key: Region key `3901` looks like it could be Canadian, but it is actually Uruguay. Always search, never guess.

Country + region conflict: If you set both `countries: ["CA"]` and `regions: [{"key": "536"}]`, Meta targets all of Canada, not just the region. Use one or the other.

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8. Post-Deploy Verification

After the deploy finishes, run these checks:

Check Meta IDs

```sql
SELECT video_title, meta_ad_id, meta_campaign_id, meta_adset_id, status
FROM video_ad_units
WHERE campaign_id = 'your-campaign-uuid';
```

Every row should have all Meta IDs populated. If any ID is null, that ad failed. Check the deploy logs.

Check Deploy Logs

```
SELECT action, status, error_message
FROM ad_deploy_log
WHERE campaign_id = 'your-campaign-uuid'
ORDER BY created_at;
```

Look for any rows with `status = 'failed'`.

Verify Pixel

```
GET https://graph.facebook.com/v21.0/{adset_id}?fields=promoted_object&access_token={token}
```

Confirm `pixel_id` is present in the response.

Verify Targeting

```
GET https://graph.facebook.com/v21.0/{adset_id}?fields=targeting&access_token={token}
```

Confirm the region key and Advantage+ audience are correct.

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9. Troubleshooting Common Issues

Video Upload Fails

Re-run the deploy. Resume support skips already-uploaded videos. If uploads keep failing:

- Check the file path exists and is readable
- Verify it is a valid MP4 (H.264 codec)

- Confirm file size is under Meta's 4GB limit
- Verify your token has `ads_management` permission

Missing Pixel

Deploy continues without a pixel and logs a warning. To fix: create a pixel in Meta Events Manager, install it on the landing page, then re-deploy.

Wrong Region Key

Update targeting directly on Meta:

```
POST https://graph.facebook.com/v21.0/{adset_id}
{
  "targeting": {
    "geo_locations": { "regions": [{"key": "correct-key"}] },
    "targeting_automation": { "advantage_audience": 1 }
  }
}
```

Partial Deploy Failure

Campaign status is set to `error`. Fix the issue, then reset:

```
UPDATE ad_campaigns SET status = 'ready', deploy_error = NULL WHERE id = 'your-campaign-
uuid';
```

Re-run the deploy. It picks up where it left off.

Token Expired or Invalid

If you used a personal token instead of a system user token, it expires after 60 days. Go back to Section 2.6 and generate a new system user token. System user tokens do not expire.

"App Not Approved" Error

New Meta apps start in Development Mode, which limits API access. For development and testing, this is fine. For production:

1. Go to your app dashboard at developers.facebook.com
2. Switch from Development to Live mode
3. You may need to complete Meta's App Review for certain permissions

For most ad deployment use cases, Development Mode is sufficient if your system user has direct access to the ad account.

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10. UTM Tracking Reference

Campaign Slug Format

```
{client-slug}-{month}-{year}-{objective}
```

Example: `acme-roofing-march-2026-leads`

Rules:

- Lowercase, hyphen-separated
- No internal tool names (never "remotion", "claude", etc.)
- No redundant date suffixes

Content Tag Format

```
v{version}-{funnel_stage}-{descriptive-slug}
```

Examples:

- `v1-tof-rate-hikes-news` (top of funnel)
- `v1-mof-customer-testimonial` (mid funnel)
- `v1-bof-free-quote-offer` (bottom of funnel)

Full URL Structure

```
{landing_page}?utm_source=meta&utm_medium=paid_social&utm_campaign={slug}&utm_content=
{content}
```

---

11. Next Steps

Monitor your campaigns. Once you activate ads in Meta Ads Manager, track spend, impressions, clicks, and cost per lead. The database stores Meta IDs so you can pull performance data programmatically.

Iterate on creative. Your first batch gives you baseline data. Use performance numbers to identify which hooks and formats work best. Render new variations and deploy with the same skill.

Scale to multiple clients. The skill is client-agnostic. Adding another client is just a database row and an ad account mapping. Same pipeline handles everything.

Follow @KyleWhitrow on Instagram for more Claude Code automation content, including how to build custom skills like this one from scratch.

Visit nustimulus.com to connect with other builders using AI-powered automation to grow their businesses.

Built with Claude Code. Deployed from the terminal.

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